

TAB 9



Board of Education Report

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Ms. Ortiz Franklin, Dr. Rivas, Ms. Gonez - Community-Based Safety Analysis and Expansion (Res-023-22/23)
(For Action 6/13/23)

Whereas, Community-based safety is the concept that community members can keep themselves safe, rather than relying on outside institutions to paternalistically take care of those who can't take care of themselves;

Whereas, Community-based safety has at its core a reimagined approach to preventing and intervening in harm with a trauma-informed lens, focused on peaceful conflict resolution and investment in community members who stay in the community long-term;

Whereas, Community-based organizations have a deep understanding of community issues, trusted relationships with the individuals and communities involved, and specific knowledge surrounding neighborhood crises;

Whereas, Community-based organizations can effectively address public safety issues, have greater impact, and save resources;

Whereas, Community-based alternative approaches to safety have strengthened the response to emergencies in places throughout the nation by preventing and reducing violence, providing care services, and decreasing unnecessary law enforcement contacts;

Whereas, The Los Angeles Unified School District has several offices, departments, and personnel who support student safety, as well as several policies and plans that support student safety, including but not limited to: the Blueprint for Safety; Integrated Safe School Plan; Safe Routes to School; Discipline Foundation Policy; Gun-Free Safe Schools, etc. and the word "safe" appears in the Parent-Student Handbook no less than 109 times;

Whereas, The Governing Board of the Los Angeles Unified School District has discussed 49 resolutions about school safety since May 1990, including thirteen resolutions in the last ten years, and the District currently partners with 27 safe passage partners;

Whereas, The May 2023 resource, "Every School Safe: A Blueprint for Safety" states "Los Angeles Unified is committed to providing every student, preschool through adult, and all members of our District and school communities with a safe, healthy, welcoming and respectful learning and working environment," and the resource encompasses the concerted efforts of District administrators, staff and community partners to ensure the environmental, physical, psychological, and social-emotional safety and well-being of our students and employees; and

Whereas, The District is currently focused on expanding partnerships and community building with Los Angeles County-based community based organizations on furthering support in student safety in

dropout prevention, safe passages, substance abuse prevention, safety collaboratives, gang prevention; now, therefore, be it

Resolved, That the Governing Board of the Los Angeles Unified School District commits to a holistic vision of school safety - including physical, emotional and intellectual safety - that (1) focuses on creating safe, welcoming, culturally- and racially-responsive school climates, (2) centers the experiences and voices of students, and (3) responds to on-campus incidents in constructive, non-criminalizing ways;

Resolved further, That the Los Angeles Unified School District and the Independent Analysis Unit will engage collaboratively with local City, County and State government officials and departments to conduct a landscape analysis of community-based safety approaches that may include:

- Convening community partners including the BSAP Steering Committee and School Culture, Climate, and Safety Task Force, with the Los Angeles County Office of Youth Diversion and Development, as well as any other relevant entities within the City and County of Los Angeles on ways to leverage Measure J, the Care First Community Initiative, and other youth development, community-based safety and/or alternatives to incarceration dollars available
- Conducting or procuring a vendor to conduct a landscape analysis of organizations doing community-based safety work in LA City and County, and develop recommendations for improved practices to connect community-based organizations to schools
- Learn about and leverage pilot programs that focus on community-based responses to non-emergency situations

Resolved further, That the District will identify and address internal barriers to expanding and implementing community-based safety partners, which may include:

- Identifying one or more third party administrator(s) that can serve as a fiscal or organizational sponsor to smaller or newer organizations to help them meet the minimum procurement qualifications (e.g. insurance limits, years of experience, etc.)
- A supportive process, similar to or inclusive of the Small Business Bootcamp, to help small or new organizations learn how to be successful with LA Unified processes
- Facilitating an “Industry Forum” with potential partners and thought leaders to understand LA Unified’s vision of school safety and how to best collaborate and calibrate; and, be it finally

Resolved, That building on the (1) Board vision for school safety and District Blueprint for Safety, (2) landscape analysis, and (3) identified and addressed internal barriers, the District will develop and publicly present a comprehensive plan by January 2024 to strengthen community-based safety approaches to improve school climate and keep school communities safe even in emergency situations.

- Such plan may refine safety and wellness policies, protocols, personnel, and practices, including who responds to what types of safety concerns and how
- Such plan shall be shared with students, families, community partners, the School Culture, Climate, and Safety Task Force, and/or other relevant groups for feedback and thought partnership
- The plan may be incorporated into the Superintendent’s presentations on the Strategic Plan and budget investments